something to help Detroit and ease the plight of its thousands of laid-off assembly-line workers.

The Japanese weren't playing fair in the trade game. But I knew what quotas might lead to; I didn't want to start an all-out trade war, so I asked if anyone had any suggestions for striking a balance between the two positions. George Bush spoke up:

"We're *all* for free enterprise, but would any of us find fault if Japan announced without any request from us that they were going to *voluntarily* reduce their export of autos to America?"

I knew the Japanese read our newspapers and must know about the sentiment building up in Congress for quotas on their cars; I also knew there must be some apprehension in Tokyo that, once Congress imposed quotas on automobiles, there was a good possibility it might try to limit imports of other Japanese products.

I liked George's idea and told the cabinet I'd heard enough and would make a decision, but didn't tell them what it was. After the meeting, I met privately with Secretary of State Al Haig and told him to call our ambassador in Tokyo, Mike Mansfield, and have him pass the word informally to Japanese Foreign Minister Masa-yoshi Ito, who was scheduled to make a visit to Washington in a few days, that pressure was building in Congress for passage of a bill establishing mandatory quotas. I told him to suggest that an announcement of a *voluntary* cutback by Japan might head it off.

During this one-on-one meeting with Haig, I was surprised by his mood. He claimed other people in the administration were trying to undercut him on matters of foreign policy, which he said was *his* territory, and he didn't want others interfering with it. He was very upset and angry. As he would do on later occasions, he pounded the table and seemed ready to explode. The intensity of his attitude